QUALITIES OF 21ST CENTURY TEACHER

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I now understand more about what it means to be a teacher today. Teaching in the 21st century is very different from teaching in the past. There is a clear comparison between old and new ways of teaching. In the 20th century, teachers filled students with information like a vessel. Students just sat and listened. But in the 21st century, teachers help students discover and learn how to learn. This change is very important.

The 21st century learner does not just sit still. They move, experiment, and ask questions. They use technology and work with others around the world. They are not passive receivers of information. Instead, they are initiators and problem solvers. This makes me think that teachers must change their methods to help these learners succeed.

There are six ways to become a 21st century educator. First, teachers should stop focusing on memorization. If teaching is only about memorizing facts, then Google can do the same job. Second, teachers must recognize that change is essential. Education needs new thinking. Third, teachers should develop a Personal Learning Network or PLN. This helps them learn and work with other teachers online. Fourth, teachers must allow students to own their learning. A quote from Jean Piaget says that schools should create people who are creative and inventive, not just people who repeat what others did. Fifth, teachers should be vulnerable with students. They should not pretend to know everything. They must show that they also make mistakes. Sixth, teachers need to integrate technology. The internet gives students access to many resources and helps them become better researchers.

There is also a self-assessment for teachers. It asks important questions about different skills and attitudes. These include oral and written communication, critical thinking, collaboration, curiosity, initiative, agility, hope, empathy, resilience, and vision for the future. These questions help teachers check if they are really helping their students grow.

In conclusion, a good 21st century teacher is not a person who gives all the answers. A good teacher is a guide who helps students ask questions, find information, work with others, and never stop learning. I believe this is the best way to prepare young people for the future.